



SNAP Lottery or Gambling Winnings

Policy 24.13

Effective: March 1, 2021

Introduction

The Tennessee Department of Human Services (TDHS) shall disqualify Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) customers for substantial Lottery or Gambling Winnings received.

Scope

This policy explains the requirements regarding disqualifications from SNAP Program due to substantial lottery or gambling winnings and when eligibility may be regained.

Policy

- A. A SNAP household shall lose eligibility immediately if any individual in the household receives cash prize from substantial lottery or gambling winnings.
- B. Substantial lottery or gambling winnings is a cash prize, before taxes or withholdings, that matches the SNAP resource limit for elderly or disabled households listed in the [Substantial Lottery and Gambling Winnings Guidelines](#) document. The limit is adjusted annually.
- C. Prizes such as goods, services, vehicles are not considered cash prizes.
- D. A cash prize must be won in one bet/ticket (such as one hit on a machine, one ticket, or one raffle) and only the amount allocated to the household member would count towards SNAP household when the household member shared in the purchase of the "ticket" or "bet" with other persons not in the household.
- E. Households classified as Categorically Eligible (CE) whose case was closed due to lottery or gambling winnings are required to meet regular SNAP rules for eligibility once they reapply and will not be considered CE status until approved one (1) certification period as a regular SNAP household.

Supporting Documents

[Tennessee Education Lottery Corporation \(TELC\) Match](#)

[Substantial Lottery and Gambling Winnings Guidelines](#)

Definitions/Acronyms

Term	Definition
SNAP	Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program
TDHS	Tennessee Department of Human Services

Supersedes

None

Authority

7 C.F.R. § 273.11(r); Tenn. Code Ann. § 4-51-133

Application

All TDHS Employees and Contractors

Revision History

Date	Version	Location of Change	Description/Reason for Change
01/22/2021	03/01/2021	New Policy	New Policy

Approval History

Approved By	Approver Title	Approved Date	Effective Date
Clarence H. Carter	Commissioner	01/22/2021	03/01/2021

Current Approver